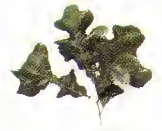


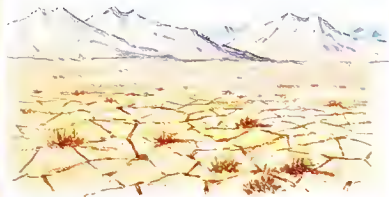


# Climates



## Did you know?

The driest place on Earth is the Atacama desert in South America. It had no rain for 400 years.



Every part of the world has its own climate, a pattern of weather that is roughly the same every year and affects the plants that grow there.



Cold forest spruce  
Scotland



## Desert climate Namibia

A desert climate is very dry. Most deserts have burning hot days and freezing cold nights.



Desert cactus

## Cold forest climate

This has long, snowy winters, and short, cool summers.



## Tropical climate

This climate is hot all year round. There is heavy rain every day for many months of the year.

Malaysia



Rain forest leaf



## Temperate climate

This climate has warm summers and cool winters. It rains most months of the year.

England



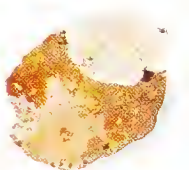
Temperate leaf



Antarctica

## Polar climate

Polar climates are cold and icy all year round. They are also very dry.



Polar lichen

## What affects the climate

### The land

The higher you climb, the colder it gets. High places, such as mountains, have cold climates.



### The sea

Places near the sea have milder climates than places inland. The summers are cool, the winters are mild.



### The sun

The sun is hotter near the equator and cooler at the poles. A place is hot or cold depending on where it lies.

